PITCHSIDE CARD

SIX WAYS TO STEP IN

Every way of interrupting a live session, from free to expensive. The way I use them: try the free ones first, and match the stoppage to who actually needs to hear it. The times are my rough estimates, not measured figures.

1 IN-FLOW

Free

REACHES: ONE PLAYER

One sentence, to one player, while everything else keeps moving.

WATCH OUT FOR

The cheapest tool you have, and the easiest to overuse. Keep it to one idea: it's still one more thing for the player to hold in mind while they play.

2 DRINKS BREAK

Free

REACHES: ANYONE

Coach inside a pause you were already taking.

WATCH OUT FOR

Free in playing time, not in attention: players are resting and often switched off. One idea, not three.

3 PULL ASIDE

About 20–30 sec

REACHES: ONE OR TWO PLAYERS, A GROUP OR A UNIT

Take one or two players out while the rest keep playing.

EARNS ITS COST

When the problem belongs to a couple of players and the rest of the group doesn't need to hear it.

4 FREEZE FRAME

About 30–45 sec

REACHES: THE WHOLE TEAM

Everything stops. Players hold their positions exactly where they are.

EARNS ITS COST

When the exact picture, at this instant, is the teaching point, and you want every player to see it rather than hear it described.

5 HUDDLE

About 60–90 sec

REACHES: THE WHOLE TEAM

Bring the whole group in, balls down.

EARNS ITS COST

When the message belongs to everyone: resetting the objective, or a shared reset after a run of chaos, not five individual corrections.

6 WALKTHROUGH

About 60–120 sec

REACHES: THE TEAM, A UNIT OR A GROUP

Rehearse the movement at walking pace, no pressure.

EARNS ITS COST

When a movement needs to be seen slowly once before it'll show up at game speed, or players can't yet do what the game asks.

Pairs with the Coaching Interaction Menu (what to say once you've stepped in). Suggestions, not rules: try one, watch what happens with your group, and adjust. More at usepitchlabs.com/learn.